

just found another source of money to apply for that you didn't know existed two minutes ago.

Simply finding what is available is more than half the battle in the search for free money. Sites like this get you on your way quicker, and it is so easy! Especially if you are looking for scholarships, check out all the community foundations in your state, county, and city. They usually have many private donors offering a wide variety of private scholarships. Ten minutes spent searching these sites could land you \$10,000 – a very wise investment of time and a wonderful investment in your future or the future of your student.

Another site to add to your favorites: <http://www.grantsolutions.gov>. This is the web address for the Grants Center of Excellence (COE). It is a partnership between agencies within Health and Human Services, Department of Agriculture, the Denali Commission, and Department of Treasury. The COE states that these partner agencies distribute over \$250 billion in grants each year. Did I just say \$250 billion? Yes, I did. That's a lot of grants. The COE serviced over \$58 billion of those grants in fiscal year 2006, which is about 13% of all US grants. This is another site worth checking out.

The CFDA, Catalog of Federal Domestic Assistance, is also a great resource. This site gives access to a database of all federal programs that are available to state and local governments. You can search and find what you are eligible for and then contact the agency or program to apply. The site is updated biweekly as new programs are posted by federal agencies. See http://12.46.245.173/pls/portal30/CATALOG.FIRST_TIME_USER_DYN.show.

There is so much information available! Are you feeling empowered and motivated? I hope so.

Now, turn the page – we're not quite done yet.